



infrastructure. He argued that these functions may improve without fundamentally changing the financial system, before raising a separate question about the risks attached to different forms of money, including commercial-bank deposits, stablecoins, and central-bank digital currencies.

Taken together, Goos and Kurovskiy described a shift in where portfolio managers create value. As AI increases access to analytical tools and blockchain makes investment activity more observable, differentiation depends increasingly on the quality of analysis, the ability to assess new technical and regulatory risks, and the capacity to explain investment decisions. Programmability also introduces its own constraints: Competing standards and infrastructures create a need for interoperability. The portfolio manager of 2035 will therefore operate across finance, technology, and regulation, while retaining judgment and trust as core professional responsibilities.

6.4 Swiss Ambition Built by Vaud, Talent, and Trust

Anthony Cohen Dumani described Vaud as Switzerland's third financial center, with strong links to the local market and economy. The canton has 191 bank branches and around 5,600 banking jobs. Its financial sector generates CHF 6.6 billion in added value, contributing more than 10% of the local economy. Tighter regulation has increased the importance of compliance, risk management, and cybersecurity.

Credit requirements have also tightened. Banks continue to finance SMEs and individuals, but they require more complete and substantiated applications before making decisions. AI can help prepare these files and accelerate certain decisions. Cohen Dumani cited the 2020 COVID-19 credit program as an example of banks acting quickly when circumstances required it, with the support of the Confederation.

Younger wealth-management clients want to have rapid access to information they can understand, and they may want their investments

to reflect particular values. Cohen Dumani expects personal advice to retain a central role. Bankers will continue to support clients with wealth transfers and succession and financial planning. Banks must provide sufficient value to discourage clients from making these decisions alone, whether over the phone or on a computer.

Knowledge and training influence the adoption of digital assets. Banks differ in their level of adoption and openness, with Cohen Dumani attributing much of advisers' hesitancy to their lack of knowledge of these products. Advisers must understand the products, take into account the regulatory framework, and determine whether the asset class fits each client's profile. Cohen Dumani argued that advisers can no longer ignore crypto-assets, placing the emphasis on continued training.

AI is already changing banking work. It can help with file preparation, asset allocation, and communication, as well as assisting employees in updating their knowledge. Access to these tools has also raised expectations of employees. Cohen Dumani expects advisers to retain a key role in client relationships. Banks will also need professionals who combine banking, AI, and financial expertise.

Professional profiles will evolve along with these tools. Cohen Dumani emphasized continuing education as a way for professionals to keep up with developments in their field. Vaud is also home to institutions such as EPFL, the University of Lausanne, and IMD. He expects sustained discussion among banks, academic institutions, Vaud's financial center, and the broader Lake Geneva region with a view to promoting educational programs that can better meet future demand.

Vaud is distinguished by its proximity to SMEs, startups, and entrepreneurs. Cohen Dumani contrasts this position with Zug's specialization in blockchain, arguing that Vaud should position itself as an innovator, potentially becoming a pioneer in sustainable finance and differentiating itself through its proximity to the local economy.

Responsible investment has become part of the discussions between advisers and clients. Banks are increasingly discussing why and where clients invest and whether these investments correspond to their preferences. Cohen Dumani also stressed the relationship between

investment quality and performance. Vaud Place Financière has adopted a charter integrating sustainable-finance criteria into the management of its own assets. He sees room for Vaud to become more prominent in sustainable finance alongside Geneva.

Looking toward 2035, Cohen Dumani identified stability, history, and confidentiality as important Swiss advantages in the current geopolitical environment. He expects Switzerland to continue to play an important role as an international financial center. Innovation and technology should remain at the forefront, while continuity in financial services remains a source of distinction.

Cohen Dumani's outlook marries technological change with a continuing role for advice and professional expertise. AI is changing banking processes and raising expectations of employees, digital assets require greater product knowledge, and changing client expectations are increasing the demands placed on advisers. In the case of Vaud, its proximity to SMEs, startups, and entrepreneurs gives it a distinctive position, with sustainable finance representing an additional area for potential development.

6.5 What Day 5 Established

Day 5 did not converge on a single technological architecture for 2035. Rabl and Vila differed on the degree of centralization that institutional DeFi may require. Homsy emphasized calibration, governance, secondary-market liquidity, and cybersecurity. Goos and Kurovskiy claimed that they expected programmable finance to expand, while standards and interoperability remain unsettled. Cohen Dumani combined technological development with continuity in advice, training, and local economic relationships. Uncertainty is itself part of the conclusion: Institutions must prepare for several plausible forms of financial infrastructure, rather than optimizing for a single prediction.

In all of these scenarios, the wealth manager's role will become more concentrated around functions that are difficult to delegate without accountability. AI can automate analysis and implementation, blockchain can make infrastructure less visible, and clients can gain more direct access to information and financial tools, but someone still has to understand the client's goals, decide which risks are acceptable, coordinate expertise, govern data, and explain the resulting decisions. Day 5 therefore turned the paper's historical question into one about the future: Which Swiss capabilities should be preserved, which must be extended, and which new capabilities must be developed if that responsibility is to remain credible in 2035?



6.5 What Day 5 Established

Speakers

Eric Rabl & Gauthier Vila

Takeaway 1

Blockchain and DeFi could become invisible financial infrastructure, with clients using them without seeing the underlying technology.

Takeaway 2

AI will change portfolio management without eliminating the wealth manager, whose role will shift toward client understanding, data quality, and risk assessment.

Takeaway 3

Institutional DeFi requires stronger security, but Rabl and Vila differ as to whether this will require greater centralization or can preserve meaningful decentralization.

Biba Homsy

Takeaway 1

Swiss resilience rests on predictability, trust, and pragmatic adaptation, rather than speed or regulatory immobility.

Takeaway 2

Digital assets must be assessed according to what they represent and how they fit with an institution's business model, rather than treated as a single uniform category.

Takeaway 3

Institutional tokenization requires secondary-market participation and liquidity. Switzerland has the legal framework for issuance; wider adoption now depends on active markets.

6.5 What Day 5 Established

Speakers

Tilmar Wilhelm Goos & Gleb Kurovskiy

Takeaway 1

AI lowers barriers to investment analysis and increases competition among investment teams. Portfolio managers still need differentiated analysis, investment selection, and the ability to explain their decisions.

Takeaway 2

Digital assets expand the scope of investment analysis. Portfolio managers must assess code, audits, and technical risks alongside financial analysis and regulation.

Takeaway 3

A more programmable financial system requires interoperability across different infrastructures and standards. Public and private networks may coexist, while tokenized products already use different technical structures.

DAY 5 showed that by 2035, wealth managers will operate across finance, technology, and regulation. AI will expand their analytical capacities, while digital assets will require them to understand new assets, infrastructure, and risks. As tools become more accessible, expertise alone will no longer define the role. Wealth managers will need to select and allocate investments, judge the quality of analysis, explain their decisions, and understand how new capabilities suit each client. Technology will broaden what wealth managers can do; judgment, responsibility, and trust will shape how they use it.

Anthony Cohen Dumani

Takeaway 1

Vaud can differentiate itself through innovation and sustainable finance, while Switzerland preserves stability, confidentiality, and high-quality service.

Takeaway 2

Personal advice retains a central role as client expectations change. Wealth transfer, succession, and financial planning continue to require support beyond digital access to information.

Takeaway 3

AI and digital assets increase the knowledge required of financial professionals. Banks need new expertise, while continuing education allows existing advisers to develop their skills.

7

From Vault to Vault: Orchestrating Wealth Management 3.0

The goal of this chapter is to draw practical lessons from the five days of interviews and panels held in Montreux in July 2026 and explore how they can be translated into practice.

At the same time, it works as a bridge between what we discussed in July 2026 and what we wish to continue to investigate in the lead-up to the 2027 Montreux Jazz Festival.

As a result, we aim to translate the key takeaways identified throughout the series into practical directions for wealth management. In order to do so, we sought to extend the concept of “Wealth Management 3.0” introduced in DAY 4 by going beyond the points tackled which focuses mostly on portfolio management. We seek to propose a comprehensive definition and a set of practical recommendations for its implementation. As such, Wealth Management 3.0 is not restricted about adding digital assets, AI or other sort of technological innovation. It is about reorganizing wealth management around a more complex object: the client’s total wealth, objectives, and ecosystem.

Four Key Learnings from the Edelvault Series

Throughout the interviews and panels, four themes emerged that together capture the key learnings from the series. The first concerns changes in *how* wealth is managed, the second one *who* contributes to its management, and the third what wealth is managed for (*why*), while the fourth one concerns *principles and values*.

These four findings collectively define four challenges for Swiss wealth management. Technology is changing how wealth is managed, as AI, digital assets, and blockchain rails expand the tools and infrastructure available to portfolio managers. Changing client needs are also expanding the goals of managing wealth, from portfolio objectives per se to succession, family purpose, philanthropy, and impact. This greater complexity entails a change in who contributes to managing wealth, requiring broader specialist expertise and more robust coordination. Across these developments, the enduring principles of the Swiss model provide continuity and a basis for implementation.

These developments provide the starting point for a comprehensive definition of Wealth Management 3.0. Two existing definitions address complementary components of the transformation. Oliver Wyman defines Wealth Management 3.0 as a scalable and modular wealth-management proposition enabled by digital transformation, while Reilly (2023) lays out a comprehensive framework for family wealth that gives greater weight to purpose, governance and transmission, philanthropy, and positive impact. Combining these perspectives, we can define Wealth Management 3.0 as *a modular model that connects financial wealth with family purpose and governance through digital capabilities and coordinated specialist expertise*.

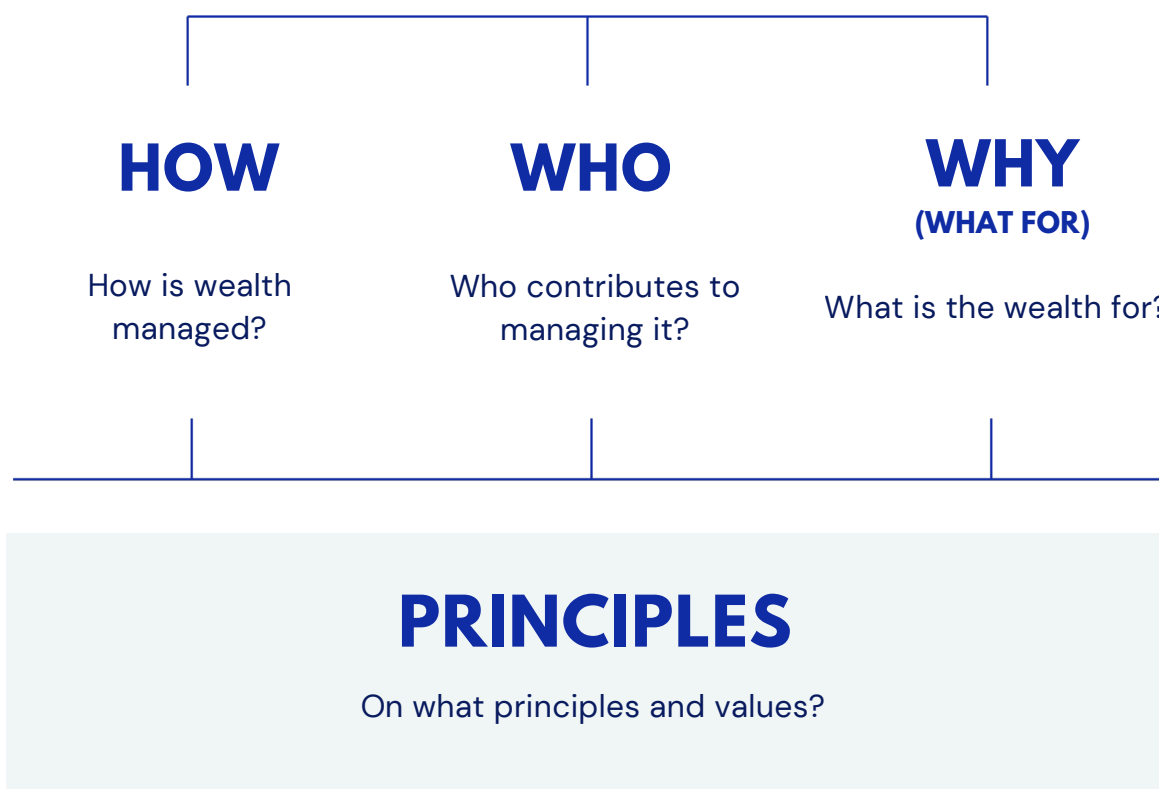
For Switzerland, the question is how this model should be implemented. Rather than inserting distinctively Swiss characteristics into the definition itself, we propose to apply the established strengths of Swiss wealth management, including trust, discretion, specialization, stability, and long-term thinking, to the way in which the model develops and operates. Wealth Management 3.0 therefore defines the model, while Switzerland's strengths provide principles governing its implementation.

This definition creates a direct link with the four themes identified previously: digital transformation addresses HOW wealth is managed, specialized and coordinated expertise addresses WHO contributes to its management, family purpose broadens our understanding of WHY wealth is managed, and the enduring principles of the Swiss model guide the implementation of the transformation.



At its core, Wealth Management 3.0 reorganizes wealth management around a broader and more complex object: the client's total wealth, objectives, and ecosystem.

A clear framework for developing practical recommendations to implement Wealth Management 3.0 can therefore be constructed.



Implementation rests on the four pillars identified above.

HOW focuses on building a modular investment and technology architecture designed to strengthen portfolio resilience. Diversification, risk allocation, and preparation for different market outcomes remain central to portfolio construction, while technology and new asset classes expand the capabilities available to portfolio managers. Human oversight and rigorous due diligence ensure that these capabilities are integrated within a controlled investment process.

WHO responds to growing specialization by giving a single adviser responsibility for maintaining a consolidated overview of the client's affairs and coordinating expertise across interconnected decisions. As more specialists contribute to managing wealth, coordination becomes essential to ensure that decisions made in one area remain consistent with the client's overall situation and objectives.

WHY defines what the family wants its wealth to achieve and uses this purpose as a reference for investment, liquidity, and structuring decisions. Governance defines how these decisions are made, while regular reviews allow both purpose and governance to evolve as the family's circumstances change.

PRINCIPLES define how Wealth Management 3.0 can build on established Swiss strengths. At the firm level, new capabilities should reinforce specialization, trust, discretion, and long-term client relationships. At the level of the financial center, stability, legal and regulatory certainty, infrastructure, and access to expertise represent the conditions under which firms can develop and apply these capabilities.

Taken together, these four pillars connect portfolio construction, technology, coordination, purpose, and Switzerland's distinctive strengths within a coherent architecture to implementing Wealth Management 3.0. They build on the key findings and knowledge shared in Montreux in 2026. As such, they also provide valuable directions for further discussion and identify areas where additional insights can be gathered as we continue to shape the future of the Swiss financial center.